

Emotion Snapshot Audit Teacher Notes

TOK Cognitive Science Activity Bank • Knowledge and the Knower • 20-30 min

Category	Knowledge and the Knower	Time	20-30 min
Difficulty	Easy	ID	emotion-snapshot-audit

Big idea: Emotion is not merely noise in knowing; it can focus, filter, and frame evidence.

Overview

Students interpret the same ambiguous scene under different emotional states and compare how feeling directs attention.

Student Prompt

Inspect Emotion Snapshot Audit Stimulus A. Record one first claim, the evidence you used, your confidence, and what would make you revise.

Concrete Stimulus Packet

Emotion Snapshot Audit Stimulus A	Student-facing stimulus 1: Scene: a student sees two friends whispering and laughing near the classroom door. Before discussing, write what you noticed, what you inferred, and how confident you are.	Students inspect this exact card first and commit to a claim before hearing anyone else.
Emotion Snapshot Audit Stimulus B	Student-facing stimulus 2: Emotion frames: anxious, excited, suspicious, calm, embarrassed, proud. Before discussing, write what you noticed, what you inferred, and how confident you are.	Use this for comparison, a second round, or a partner challenge.
Emotion Snapshot Audit Reveal / Twist	Student-facing stimulus 3: Emotion frames: anxious, excited, suspicious, calm, embarrassed, proud. Before discussing, write what you noticed, what you inferred, and how confident you are.	Teacher reveal: connect the changed response to the big idea — Emotion is not merely noise in knowing; it can focus, filter, and frame evidence.

Actual Lesson Questions and Key

#	Question for students	Teacher key / cue
1	After inspecting Emotion Snapshot Audit Stimulus A, what is your first knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: look for a clear claim, not just a description.
2	Which exact detail from Emotion Snapshot Audit Stimulus A did you use as evidence?	Teacher cue: students should name visible words, data, source features, method features, or contextual clues.
3	What did you infer beyond the evidence?	Teacher cue: this is where assumptions, framing, models, or perspective usually appear.
4	How confident are you: 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%, 90%, or 100%?	Teacher cue: confidence is data for the debrief, not a grade.
5	What missing information would most improve the knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: push for method, source, context, comparison, or definitions.
6	How does emotion shape what knowers notice?	Teacher cue: students should move from the classroom example to a general TOK issue.

Teacher Key / Reveal

The key move is not the “right answer”; it is the moment students see how emotion is not merely noise in knowing; it can focus, filter, and frame evidence.

- Strong response: separates observation from inference.
- Strong response: names a method, source, model, language choice, context, or perspective.
- Strong response: revises confidence when new evidence or a new criterion appears.
- Weak response: gives only opinion or says “it depends” without criteria.

Setup Checklist

- Use fictional emotion cards rather than asking students to disclose their actual mood.
- Choose an ambiguous image or short scene with several plausible interpretations.

Ready-to-Use Examples

- Scene: a student sees two friends whispering and laughing near the classroom door.
- Emotion frames: anxious, excited, suspicious, calm, embarrassed, proud.

Suggested Timing

Stage	Teacher move	Watch for
1	Show students the same ambiguous stimulus without discussion.	Assumptions, confidence shifts, evidence claims, and language choices.
2	Assign groups different emotion frame cards.	Assumptions, confidence shifts, evidence claims, and language choices.
3	Groups list what details they notice, what they infer, and what they ignore.	Assumptions, confidence shifts, evidence claims, and language choices.
4	Compare interpretations across emotion frames.	Assumptions, confidence shifts, evidence claims, and language choices.
5	Debrief emotion as evidence, filter, and interpretive context.	Assumptions, confidence shifts, evidence claims, and language choices.
Debrief	Move from the activity result to a TOK knowledge question.	Students distinguishing method, evidence, interpretation, and overclaiming.

Teacher Language

- Emotion did not add new visual evidence, but it changed which details mattered.
- When might emotion help you notice something important?

Common Misconceptions

- Students may treat perception or memory as a recording device.
- Students may assume confidence is evidence rather than a feeling about evidence.

Assessment Look-Fors

- Separates perception, memory, belief, confidence, and justification.
- Uses the activity result to make a cautious claim about knowers.

Differentiation and Adaptations

- Support: use two emotion frames only.
- Challenge: ask students to identify when emotion provides relevant evidence.

Extension Tasks

- Students compare emotion in eyewitness testimony, art interpretation, and ethical judgement.
- Create a checking routine for emotionally charged knowledge claims.

Related Activities

- Perspective Glasses
- One Image, Many Readings
- Music and Emotion Experiment